Kevin Rajan

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Education

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign — Urbana-Champaign, IL

Bachelor of Science in Engineering Physics, Minor in Computer Science — *Graduated May 2020*

- Certificate in Technology Commercialization
- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures (CS 225), Computer Architecture (CS 233), Honors Systems Programming (CS 241), Operating Systems Design (CS 423), Compilers (CS 421), Text Information Systems (CS 410), Applied Machine Learning (CS 498), Parallel Programming (CS 484), Computer Graphics (CS 418), Virtual Reality (CS 498)

Professional Experience

Founder & CEO — Jun. 2024 – Present

zero, LLC — *Remote*

- Landed 41 commits on **NousResearch/hermes-agent** main (Aug.–Oct. 2026) across runtime correctness (cron, gateway watchdog, config signatures), context-compaction safety, kanban, desktop, and platform adapters; opened 194 PRs and 161 issues and commented on 1,272 threads upstream.
- Built **Hermes Tern**, a native terminal UI for Hermes (plan review, forked sessions, OpenUI previews, voice), and **Dash**, an Expo phone app plus Bun bridge over Tailscale that keeps one live thread per agent harness (Hermes, Codex, Claude Code, OMP, Grok); both in daily use.
- Designed **z0**, a registry and installer for a personal agent stack (evidence-routed decisions, typed intent contracts, token economics, reproducible evals), and a verified open-source loop (leased claims, isolated worktrees, evidence receipts, human merge); 151 merged PRs in 44 external projects.
- Design intricate digital twin simulations to prototype AI factories and industrialize entire feedback loops to implement systems-thinking. Implemented efficient, reproducible development environments (NixOS, Ubuntu, Arch, Kubernetes) for on-prem compute by researching best practices, resulting in a reduction of operating costs by 50%.

LLM Training Specialist — Jan. 2025 – Present

Outlier (Scale AI) — *Remote*

- Designed and applied detailed rubrics for LLM evaluation, writing complex logic, math, and physics prompts to elicit reasoning failures and guide model improvement through process-supervision feedback. Performed red-teaming and fact-checking across STEM and general-knowledge domains, verifying claims with web sources and explaining weaknesses in model reasoning to refine future outputs.
- Conducted large-scale preference labeling and comparative ranking of multiple LLMs (RLHF, DPO, RLAIF) while drafting critiques that articulated why certain completions failed rubric standards. Developed multimodal and tool-use evaluations integrating text, image, and retrieval tasks to measure grounding, reliability, and reasoning depth across diverse model architectures.

Self-Directed Ultralearning — Jul. 2023 – Jun. 2024

Sabbatical — *Naperville, IL*

- Engineered a holistic performance optimization system to enhance cognitive and motor skills, applying an algorithmic feedback loop (Research, Implement, Analyze, Iterate) to systematically correlate and refine inputs, including sleep, nutrition, and specialized training protocols.
- Executed a long-term data-driven analysis project to benchmark and optimize rapid skill acquisition; successfully reverse-engineered complex, dynamic systems to identify and eliminate bottlenecks, culminating in validated performance metrics within the top 1–5% of a 25M+ user environment (Kovaaks, Valorant, Apex).

Senior Consultant, Technology Enablement — Jun. 2021 – Jul. 2023

Slalom Consulting — *Chicago, IL*

- Collaborated within a multi-disciplinary team to enhance client ($4B+ revenue finance firm) engagement while modernizing technology systems across 12 teams and verticals. Mitigated obstacles for business unit teams using enhanced software processes and workflows, promoting Agile/DevOps/CI/CD concepts by utilizing AWS, Jenkins, Terraform and Vault.
- Improved developer impact by creating tailored pipelines that publish biweekly golden Windows and RHEL releases, ultimately ensuring security standards within custom AMIs.

- Spearheaded the creation of a centralized knowledge base, curating exemplary business documents like SPROs, customer stories, qualifiers, and evaluations across technological and business administrative platforms to enhance company-wide accessibility post-sanitization and lay the groundwork for AI-driven content generation.
- Championed a comprehensive DevOps training program tailored for over 500 new hires, ensuring a smooth transition into the company's technology ecosystem. Designed an engaging onboarding session anchored around point poker, fostering collaboration and hands-on learning. Orchestrated multi-cloud environments to provide an interactive, holistic, real-world experience of the best practices we use with our clients.
- Steered the conceptualization of a preventative health platform acting as product owner. Orchestrated the amalgamation of diverse health data sources, from wearables to full metabolic/blood panels. Initiated outreach to several health tech leaders and experts to gather insights, shaping preliminary ideas for platform features. Prioritized areas of focus by aligning the platform with cutting-edge health research and its potential for predictive analysis and enhanced patient outcomes.

Software Engineer May 2019 – Aug. 2019
Synchrony Financial *Chicago, IL*

AWS Developer (EC2 Fargate) Aug. 2018 – Jan. 2019
Amazon *Seattle, WA*

- Increase response time in identifying customer container issues by conceptualizing and integrating pool metrics that allow developers to understand the state of the world.
- Automate modifying customer's compute capacity through an automatic pool management system that algorithmically detects customer traffic spikes.

Technology Enterprise Architect Jun. 2018 – Aug. 2018
BlueCross BlueShield (HCSC) *Chicago, IL*

- Execute individual contributor projects that become inputs and contribute toward HCSC's enterprise data strategy.
- Convert technical data to ideas and concepts that encourage pursuit of strategy or solicit action.

iOS Engineer / UX Engineer Jul. 2017 – Feb. 2018
Prenosis Inc. *Champaign, IL*

- Designed an iOS application from scratch that allows physicians to manage various patients' lab results, vitals, imaging results, and other significant statistics.
- Integrated a feature called Prenosis Number, which acts as a risk stratification value that allows physicians to prioritize the order in which they see the patients.
- Created a cross-functional feature such that physicians can access patients' past medical history, prescriptions, and doctor notes, as well as prescribe new medications.

Software Engineering Intern May 2016 – Jul. 2016
Wipro Consulting *Chennai, India*

- Parsed data from IBM Cognos and converted it to a Tableau data source to facilitate an efficient transition between big data platforms so that clients could move towards more modern data management systems.
- Developed a data source extractor that imports large amounts of raw information from distributed servers to create a final Tableau data source by accessing various queries and filters applied on the collected data sets.

Freelance iOS Contractor / UI Designer Jan. 2016 – Jul. 2016
ByteBros. *Champaign, IL*

- Implemented a multi-view iOS application using payment API methods including Venmo and PayPal for a client that allows users to rent commonplace items from each other.
- Utilized Facebook logins to generate user accounts in Firebase to store preferences and rent history.

Leadership

iOS Developer Jan. 2017 – May 2018
HackIllinois *Champaign, IL*

- Developed an iOS application that allows about 15k people (hackers, mentors, recruiters) to have a seamless experience during the 36-hour student-run hackathon, allowing them to check into events, check out hardware, and get food. Raised $300k+ from event sponsors for operational costs and prizes.

Open Source Coordinator Aug. 2015 – May 2016
HackIllinois *Champaign, IL*

- Managed the open source initiative, a pilot program that expanded to become the main attraction for several leading technology firms and open source groups.
- Invited 40 mentors from across the nation, who had strong backgrounds in open source, to oversee a group of hackers contributing to existing projects and creating new ones.

Sponsorship Staff Aug. 2015 – May 2016
HackIllinois *Champaign, IL*

- Raised over $300,000 by building long-lasting relationships with over 120 corporations.
- Streamlined relations between the staff and sponsoring corporations to guarantee an inviting corporate experience during the event while managing several other logistics of the hackathon.

Admin Committee / Corporate Committee Aug. 2016 – May 2017
Association for Computing Machinery *Champaign, IL*

- Manage ACM's website and Active User Directory while maintaining servers for special interest groups.
- Maintain professional relations between the university and various corporations to facilitate hosting tech talks.
- Increase funding for workplace hardware supplies by establishing strong relationships with corporate sponsors.

Class Coordinator / iOS Developer Jan. 2016 – Jul. 2016
CodePath University Partnership *Champaign, IL*

- Handled logistics for classroom locations after creating the bridge between CodePath University and UIUC to lecture and stimulate discussion within an iOS bootcamp lab to teach students basic iOS programming.
- Developed several unique iOS applications each week by utilizing various CocoaPods and APIs, including an app that shows current and trending movies and TV shows using TMDB.

Projects

Quackles (Microduck product study) 2026

- Product page homage to the Hermes Agent poster: Blender Cycles plates in five themes and a 201 MP deep-zoom master served as a WebP tile pyramid.
- The same pyramid backs an infinite-canvas portfolio with semantic zoom: overview, summaries, details, then commit-level evidence.

RoutinePlus Jan. 2017 – Jun. 2017

- Designed and prototyped an iOS alarm clock application with Figma and Framer by following material design guidelines that sets intelligent alarms by analyzing calendar entries.
- Automated integration with HomeKit based on the user's routine, location and preferences to control smarthome products such as thermostats, coffee brewers, TVs, and home security.

Flight Simulator Oct. 2016 – Dec. 2016

- Created a flight simulator in WebGL by applying transformation matrices and rotation quaternions onto the camera, in which the terrain is randomly generated using the Diamond-Square algorithm.
- Extended the flight simulator to Unity with virtual reality support on the Oculus, in which the flight is a more detailed mesh to appear more realistic to the player.

Nanotechnology Research Oct. 2016 – Dec. 2016

- Synthesized biocompatible nanoparticles used for newer bioimaging techniques by researching the effect on carbon nanoparticles' absorption spectrums through the variation of polymeric coatings.
- Sharpened the absorption peaks of passivated nanoparticles by analyzing the properties of different polymers.

Technical Skills

DevOps: AWS, Terraform, Jenkins, Azure
Languages: Python, C++, C, Java, Haskell
AI & LLMs: Hermes Agent, Claude Code, Codex, OpenCode, ACP, MCP, context engineering, evals
Design: Photoshop, Figma, GIMP, Sketch, Zeplin
iOS: Xcode, Swift, jazzy-docs, cocoapods
Web: TypeScript, React, React Native/Expo, Electron, HTML, CSS, WebGL
3D: Maya, Unity, Blender, AfterEffects, Inventor, Unreal Engine
Data Analytics: pandas, Tableau, Cognos, PowerBI